



ASIKO TV

THE SOUL OF AFRICA

— NICHE & MITIGATIONS

The corner we own, and how we **close every gap**

Deep pockets don't always win. This is the niche Asiko starts from, a mitigation for every weakness, and how voting for cash prizes changes the numbers.

1 • The niche — where we sit and grow from

The African-owned, diaspora-first FAST platform that **co-owns the monetisation with the industry — not a neutral carrier, not a walled garden.**

Asiko is not just "another platform that carries channels." Media Icons **owns ~28 of the 100+ channels** as the spine, **partners** with the industry for the rest, and is **vested in the ad-server, the commercials and the monetisation** — for itself and for its channels. It also **trains, builds, and runs the voting and prize formats** that give creators monetisation routes AVO doesn't offer.

The beachhead — start narrow, win completely

- ♦ **Who:** the African diaspora in the **UK and US first**, then Canada and the EU. On **connected TV and web** — where they already watch and where data cost isn't a barrier.
- ♦ **What they get:** ~28 Media-Icons channels as a dependable spine, partner channels for breadth, and formats — competitions, voting, cash prizes — that make it appointment television, not background noise.

- ♦ **Who pays:** a **category-exclusive anchor sponsor** per sector — remittance, telecom, banking, travel, education — brands that have no clean way to reach this audience today, sold directly by a 30-year media-sales operator.

Why this niche holds against deep pockets

MOAT	WHY MONEY CAN'T JUST BUY PAST IT
Ownership authenticity	"African-owned, African stories controlled by Africans" is true at the cap tal UK-owned or US-owned rival can spend more and still not say it.
Industry relationships	Thirty years of trust with content owners, advertisers and associations (MIP ADVAN) — built with time, not cheques. A newcomer with capital still starts
The 28-channel spine	You control supply and quality directly — unlike a pure aggregator who is or good as who signs up. It also means you can make the MVP real immediatel
Co-owned monetisation	Partners share in the upside and the ad-server, so they're aligned, not mere carried. That's a switching cost a bigger cheque doesn't remove.
Many revenue lines	Build fees + playout + ad rev-share + category sponsorship + training + voti single-line competitor (programmatic ads only) is fragile where you are dive
A market the giants ignore	Netflix and Prime chase global subscribers; AVO chases mass on-continent The Western diaspora as its own served audience is nobody's priority — ye

The pattern in streaming: focused challengers beat incumbents by owning a community or an identity the incumbent can't replicate — Crunchyroll in anime, BET+ and ALLBLK in Black American content. Asiko's version is African-diaspora culture, owned by Africans.

The growth path from the beachhead

Diaspora UK/US → all Western diaspora → the 110-channel line-up → on-continent Africa (with telco zero-rating removing the data barrier) → adjacent formats (Asiko Cinemas / TVOD, live events). Each step funded by the one before.

2 • Every weakness, mitigated

WEAKNESS	MITIGATION	OWNER
Pre-revenue simulation	The 28 owned channels mean the MVP can be made real fast — one real channel end to end, first invoice, inside the 6–8 week plan.	ME + YOU

WEAKNESS	MITIGATION	OWNER
Tiny team	Rent the bench, don't hire it: FOA / a build partner / managed ops for engineering & on-call; one ad-ops and one scheduler contractor at pilot; the founder's network as advisory.	YOU
No content	Reframe — you have a content <i>engine</i> : 28 owned channels (spine) + an industry-partnership pipeline + a public-domain / licensed starter library + partner feeds via FOA. Not a catalogue gap.	YOU
Bootstrapped	Non-dilutive first: pre-sell a category-exclusive anchor (a telecom or remittance brand), pursue cultural / development grants, use FOA build fees as early cash. Then a small seed against the POC + letters of intent — not a big round.	YOU
Web only	PWA at MVP (same codebase); a web-based Roku channel at pilot; native CTV apps via a build partner / aggregator after.	ME
asiko.africa not live	DNS records at the registrar today (see §4); five minutes on my side after it resolves.	YOU
Key-person risk	Document everything (this doc set is the start); bring in a co-founder or senior hire in content/ops; an advisory board drawn from the associations.	YOU
Measurement not real	A beacon endpoint at MVP → a monthly per-channel statement partners trust → third-party validation (Comscore / Nielsen) at scale.	ME
No ad demand signed	This is a strength in disguise — the founder <i>sells</i> the anchor deal directly, pre-launch. An SSP is added only for programmatic backfill once there's audience.	YOU
Voting has no backend	The mock proves the UX now; a lightweight voting service at pilot — in-app with anti-fraud, and SMS/USSD via a telco partner (which also makes it a revenue line).	ME + TELCO
Compliance unbuilt	A lawyer drafts Privacy + Terms + the NDPA position before real ads; the consent banner is wired at MVP; NBC / APCON / music-society advice taken early.	YOU + LAWYER

Three of these — content, ad demand, "not just a carrier" — flip to **strengths** once the 28-channel spine and the founder's direct ad sales are stated plainly. The SWOT is being updated to reflect that.

3 · Voting for cash prizes — how it changes usage & streaming

AVO monetises impressions. Voting monetises **participation** — a second, higher-margin layer, and the thing FAST channels usually lack: a reason to show up at a specific time.

EFFECT	WHY IT HAPPENS	WHAT IT DOES FOR THE PLATFORM
Appointment viewing	A live final at a set time; weekly eliminations	Tune-in spikes — the scheduled FAST channels rarely get
Longer sessions	"Watch the episode to unlock your vote"	Higher watch-time per session — ad impressions
Repeat visits	Multi-week competitions build a weekly return habit	Retention and frequency, not just acquisition
First-party data	Voting is the low-friction reason to create a light account (email / phone)	Your first real CRM — without getting the channels. AVO's "register for a contest" pattern, tied to something people actually want to do
Free acquisition	Contestants mobilise their own audiences to vote; the cash prize raises the stakes and the sharing	New viewers at near-zero CAC
Premium sponsorship	"Presented by", prize sponsor, voting sponsor	Sponsorship inventory at a premium — standard spots
A voting revenue line	SMS / USSD voting via a telco partner carries a per-vote fee	A share of that fee — margin AVO doesn't have. Works on a feature phone, no data — pairs with zero-rating
Creator monetisation beyond AVO	Prize money + platform exposure + a share of voting / sponsorship	Delivers the "opportunities beyond AVO monetises" promise — and creators want to be on Asiko

Manage these risks

- ♦ **Vote fraud** — cap votes per user, phone verification, rate limits, anomaly detection.
- ♦ **Regulation** — paid-voting and prize-competition rules vary by country; take advice per market before launching one.
- ♦ **Prize economics** — prizes must be **sponsor-funded**, not carried on the P&L. No sponsor, no cash prize that quarter.

The metric to watch: votes per viewer, and week-over-week return rate during a competition versus a normal week. If a competition week returns 2–3× the normal repeat rate, the format is working and you scale it.

4 · Directing the POC to asiko.africa — what I need from you

One thing: the DNS. In your registrar (Namecheap) → Domain List → `asiko.africa` → Manage → **Advanced DNS**:

- ♦ Delete the parking `CNAME` on host `www`, and any `URL Redirect Record` on host `@`.
- ♦ Add four **A Records**, host `@` → `185.199.108.153`, `185.199.109.153`, `185.199.110.153`, `185.199.111.153`.
- ♦ Add one **CNAME Record**, host `www` → `johnupah-dev.github.io`.
- ♦ Confirm the domain is on **Namecheap BasicDNS**, not parking / web-hosting DNS.

Tell me it's saved. I add `asiko.africa` as the custom domain on GitHub with a `CNAME` file; GitHub issues the HTTPS certificate automatically. Live within a few minutes to a couple of hours after propagation.

Alternatives

- ♦ **Prefer not to touch Namecheap DNS?** Move the domain's nameservers to **Cloudflare** (free) and I'll serve it through Cloudflare Pages — faster globally and it sidesteps any `github.io`-style filtering (the "blank on mobile" issue). Needs a free Cloudflare account.
- ♦ **DNS managed at Hostinger?** Give me access to that DNS zone and I'll add the records there.

Asiko TV — niche, mitigations & the voting effect

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